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Location-aware collaboration communications

Abstract

Presented herein are techniques associated with facilitating location-aware collaboration communications among multiple users. In one example a method is provided that may include determining that a non-primary user of a first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device; and based on determining that a primary user of the first collaboration device is not proximate to the first collaboration device, enabling the non-primary user to utilize the first collaboration device to initiate communication with at least one second collaboration device of the primary user.

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Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to network equipment and services.

BACKGROUND

(2) In hybrid work environments, employees are more transient. In such environments, employees often utilize multiple devices, such as smartphones, laptops, and tablets to perform job functions.

The utilization of different devices creates new opportunities to improve interactions among employees that can utilize different devices at different locations.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of a system in which techniques that facilitate location aware collaboration communications may be implemented, according to an example embodiment.
- (2) FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating an example use case in which collaboration communications may be disabled for a non-primary user of a collaboration device, according to an example embodiment.
- (3) FIG. 3 is a flow chart depicting a method according to an example embodiment.
- (4) FIG. 4 is a flow chart depicting another method according to an example embodiment.
- (5) FIG. 5 is a hardware block diagram of a computing device that may perform functions associated with any combination of operations, in connection with the techniques discussed herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(6) Overview

- (7) The change from an office-centric work environment to hybrid work environments involving a mix of corporate office employees and home office (e.g., at an employee's residence) or otherwise remote employees (e.g., potentially able to work from any location in the world) has caused enterprises to reevaluate their capital expenditures for office devices, which—at least in the corporate office setting—can represent a waste of money for an enterprise entity (e.g., a business entity, a governmental entity, an educational entity, etc.) when such devices go unused by employees that are working remotely.
- (8) In some instances, it may be possible to use high value physical endpoints to display static office guidance, however, such uses of physical endpoints are merely the tip of the iceberg in terms of contextual information that could be provided to employees or, more generally, enterprise users.
- (9) In a hybrid environment, where corporate offices are at lower occupancy and users are more transient, it would be advantageous to better harness the value of endpoint devices, such as smart screens/displays, communication devices, etc., broadly referred to herein as “collaboration devices” in order to enable communications among users both within an office (e.g., local or in-person users) and outside the office (e.g., remote users).
- (10) Proposed herein are techniques that can be utilized to “bridge the gap” between remote and in-person workers in order to provide opportunities for improved interaction among a higher portion of the workforce, thereby improving value that can be provided by collaboration devices owned/operated by an enterprise entity. In particular, techniques herein may provide for enabling location-aware collaboration communications between an in-office user and a remote user via a collaboration device associated with the remote user that is located in-office, proximate to the in-office user.
- (11) In at least one embodiment, a computer-implemented method is provided that may include determining that a non-primary user of a first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device, and based on determining that a primary user of the first collaboration device is not proximate to the first collaboration device, enabling the non-primary user to utilize the first collaboration device to initiate communication with at least one second collaboration device of the primary user. In one instance, determining that the non-primary user of the first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device can be based on the first collaboration device detecting a third collaboration device (e.g., a personal or corporate/enterprise mobile phone) that is associated with the non-primary user being proximate to the first collaboration device (e.g., via wireless interactions, etc. between the first collaboration device and the third collaboration device).

Example Embodiments

(12) In a hybrid environment, where offices are at lower occupancy and users are more transient it would be useful to better harness the value of endpoint or collaboration devices, such as smart screens/displays, communication devices (e.g., laptops, tablets, smartphones, etc.), and/or the like, in order to enable communications among users both within an office (e.g., local or in-person users) and outside the office (e.g., remote users). For example, a large number of personal video endpoint devices remain in offices and are often not used in hybrid work environments involving many remote users, which can lead to depreciation of such devices.

(13) In accordance with embodiments herein, techniques are provided that help to “bridge the gap” between remote and in-person workers in order to provide opportunities for improved interaction among a higher portion of the workforce, thereby improving value that can be provided by collaboration devices owned/operated by an enterprise entity. In particular, techniques herein may provide for enabling location-aware collaboration communications between an in-office user and a remote user via a collaboration device associated with the remote user that is located in-office, proximate to the in-office user. Such features for enabling location-aware collaboration communications may be referred to herein as a “shoulder tap” feature in which the in-office user can “shoulder tap” the remote user for collaborating/communicating via various collaboration devices.

(14) Referring to FIG. 1, FIG. 1 is a block diagram of a system **100** in which techniques that facilitate location-aware collaboration communications may be implemented, according to an example embodiment.

(15) A number of collaboration devices may be present in system **100** in which each collaboration device can be associated with a given user (e.g., enterprise employee, etc.). In accordance with embodiments herein, a user that is associated with a particular collaboration device is considered to be a “primary” user of the particular collaboration device (e.g., the primary user “tied-to” the particular collaboration device via a user identity or identifier (ID), subscription, certificate, etc. maintained or provisioned for the particular device). Conversely, a user that is not associated with the particular collaboration device, but who can utilize the particular collaboration device in accordance with embodiments herein is considered to be a “non-primary” user of the collaboration device.

(16) As illustrated in FIG. 1, collaboration devices **102A-1** and **102A-2** are associated with a user **101A**, which is considered to be the primary user of collaboration devices **102A-1** and **102A-2**. Collaboration device **102B-1** that is associated with a user **101B** is also shown in FIG. 1 such that user **101B** is considered to be the primary user of collaboration device **102B-1** and can be considered to be a non-primary user of collaboration device **102A-1** (and of collaboration device **102A-2**) in accordance with embodiments herein. Similarly, user **101A** can be considered to be a non-primary user of collaboration device **102B-1**.

(17) FIG. 1 illustrates two locations at which the collaboration devices can be located. For example, a location **110** can be considered a “local” or “in-office” location at which collaboration device **102A-1** and user **101B**/collaboration device **102B-1** are located such that user **101B** is considered to be proximate to or physically near collaboration device **102A-1**. In various embodiments, location **110** may be representative of a corporate office of an enterprise entity (e.g., business entity, government entity, educational entity, etc.) associated with both user **101A** and user **101B** in which the enterprise entity facilitates collaboration communications among collaboration devices **102A-1**, **102A-2**, and **102B-1** via a calling or collaboration service **130**. In various embodiments, collaboration service **130** can be representative of any service that facilitates data, audio, and/or video communications among collaboration devices **102A-1**, **102A-2**, and **102B-1** via any combination of communication technologies, such as cellular communication technologies, Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) 802.11 communication technologies, and/or the like.

(18) A location **120** shown in FIG. 1 can be considered a “remote” location at which user **101A**/collaboration device **102A-2** are located such that user **101A** is considered to be proximate to or physically near collaboration device **102A-2**. Location **120** may be considered to be remote relative to location **110** in that location **120** may be geographically remote or separated away from location **110** by some physical distance such that user **101A** would not be considered to be proximate to or physically near collaboration device **102A-1**.

(19) Each collaboration device **102A-1**, **102A-2**, and **102B-1** may be associated with any person, user, subscriber, employee, client, customer, and/or the like for which collaboration communications may be facilitated/managed by a given enterprise entity via collaboration service **130** and may be inclusive of any device that initiates a communication in the system, such as a computer, a laptop or electronic notebook, a cellular/Wi-Fi enabled telephone/smart phone, tablet, etc. and/or any other device, component, element, or object capable of initiating voice, audio, video, media, or data exchanges within system **100**. Each collaboration device **102A-1**, **102A-2**, and **102B-1** may include corresponding communication input/output (I/O) interface(s) each of which may include any combination of hardware (e.g., communications units, receiver(s), transmitter(s), antenna(s) and/or antenna array(s), processor(s), memory element(s), baseband processor(s) (modems), etc.), controllers (e.g., wireless local area network controllers, etc.), software, logic, and/or any other elements/logic that may facilitate wireless and/or wired communications and/or connections among one or more elements of system **100**.

(20) It is to be understood that each collaboration device **102A-1**, **102A-2**, and **102B-1** may include/be configured with any other hardware, software, operating system, I/O interfaces, processor(s), memory element(s), storage, etc. to facilitate/interface with one or more displays, keyboards, microphones, speakers, etc. In accordance with embodiments herein collaboration devices can be provisioned/configured with any combination of software, logic, etc., such as control logic **104A-1** that can be configured for collaboration device **102A-1** as shown in FIG. 1.

(21) In various embodiments, control logic **104A-1** can include instructions that, when executed, cause processor(s) (not shown) of collaboration device **102A-1** to perform operations, which can include, but not be limited to, providing overall control operations of collaboration device **102A-1**; interacting with other entities, elements, systems, etc. described herein; maintaining and/or interacting with stored data, information, parameters, etc. (e.g., memory element(s), storage, data structures, databases, tables, etc.), for example, to determine user information, permission information, status information, etc. for primary and/or non-primary user(s) of collaboration device **102A-1**; combinations thereof; and/or the like to facilitate various operations for embodiments described herein. In some embodiments, control logic **104A-1** may be implemented in whole or in part as an application programming interface (API), such as a status API or the like to facilitate operations as discussed for embodiments herein.

(22) During operation in accordance with embodiments herein, user proximity detection can be provided based on sensor fusion. Generally, sensor fusion is a process through which data can be combined from multiple disparate sources (e.g., multiple collaboration devices and/or multiple sensors on the same physical devices, such as cameras, radio frequency (RF) chips, etc.) such that the resultant combined data provides less uncertainty than may otherwise be possible from data obtained from each source individually. In accordance with embodiments herein, user proximity detection can be provided based on sensor fusion in which collaboration devices can be associated with different users (e.g., primary versus (vs) non-primary users).

(23) Through embodiments discussed herein, efficient collaboration communications can be provided in hybrid work environments using user proximity detection, which can be provided using any proximity detection techniques now known in the art or hereinafter developed. For example, consider a scenario involving system **100** in which a more natural hybrid work style can be enabled by providing features for collaboration devices whereby non-primary users, such as user **101B**, who are not owners or primary users of an owned (e.g., logged-in) personal collaboration device,

such as collaboration device **102A-1**, are proximate to the collaboration device, the non-primary user of the collaboration device, user **101B** in this example, can “tap on the shoulder” (“shoulder tap”) of the primary user that is not proximate to the collaboration device **102A-1**, user **101A** in this example, in order to initiate communication with another collaboration device with which the primary user is proximate, such as collaboration device **102A-2**. By “not proximate” or “not near” collaboration device **102A-1**, it is meant that user **101A** is not at the same physical location as collaboration device **102A-1**, location **110** (e.g., user **101A** is not at their desk or in their office where collaboration device **102A-1** is located) but rather users **101A** is at a remote location, such as location **120**, and is proximate to collaboration device **102A-2**.

(24) Such a feature would be available when a non-primary user is in proximity of a particular collaboration device, while the owner/primary user of the particular collaboration device is not in proximity of the particular collaboration device. In one embodiment, when tapped (e.g., via a user interface (UI) interaction of a UI “call” button or the like on a touch screen of the given collaboration device), the particular collaboration device could initiate a video call to the primary user that is assigned or otherwise associated to the particular collaboration device. The call could be initiated with another collaboration device of the primary user, which could be determined through intelligent device selection. In one embodiment, status information could be displayed on the particular collaboration device to avoid a non-primary user initiating a call with a primary user that has a status set, for example, to “Do not Disturb” or who is busy in another meeting.

(25) In another embodiment, the particular collaboration device could automatically initiate a call with another device of the primary user without the non-primary user interacting with the particular collaboration device. For example, a call to the endpoint owner of a particular collaboration device could be automatically initiated (e.g., with zero physical contact by a non-primary user with the collaboration device) based on detecting that a non-primary user is proximate to the collaboration device while the primary user of the device is not proximate to the device.

(26) In one embodiment, the process of initiating a call or joining a teleconference could be made more personal by using functionality in which an image of the calling (non-primary) user could be displayed via a collaboration device of the primary user in order for the primary user to determine who is calling before answering the call.

(27) In some embodiments, call security could be provided for a primary user such that upon detection of a foreign user being proximate to a collaboration device that would otherwise enable a call to the primary user, such as collaboration device **102A-1**, sensitive functionality, such as but not limited to, one-button call join functionality, functionality that could perceivably display sensitive user information (e.g., calendar information, etc.), and/or the like could be inhibited or disabled on the collaboration device **102A-1** (e.g., to avoid foreign users from snooping on others' meetings and bypassing protections using that user's privileges). For example, if a foreign user that is not associated with/employed by the enterprise entity associated with collaboration device **102A-1** is detected as being proximate to the device, then functionality to enable a call to the primary user **101A** could be disabled on collaboration device **102A-1**.

(28) In some embodiments, intelligent selection of a collaboration device that is to receive a call can be facilitated via collaboration service **130** by determining the presence or proximity of a primary user with a given collaboration device, such as with collaboration device **102A-2**. In one embodiment, presence may be determined based information gathered for multiple collaboration devices associated with a primary user. For example, a laptop of the primary user detecting the presence of the primary user's smartphone could be used to determine that the primary user is proximate to the laptop. In another embodiment, log-in history could be used to determine the presence of the primary user for a given collaboration device. For example, the primary user being logged into a calling service on a particular collaboration device could be used to determine that the user is proximate or present at the particular collaboration device.

(29) Accordingly, operations facilitated via system **100** that provide for location-aware

collaboration communications may include, but not be limited to, determining that a non-primary user of a first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device (e.g., user **101B** is determined to be proximate to collaboration device **102A-1** that is associated with (primary) user **101A**) and, based on determining that the primary user of the first collaboration device is not proximate to the first collaboration device (e.g., user **101A** is at location **120** and, thus, is not proximate to collaboration device **102A-1**), enabling the non-primary user (e.g., user **101B**) to utilize the first collaboration device (e.g., collaboration device **102A-1**) to initiate communication with at least one second collaboration device of the primary user (e.g., collaboration device **102A-2**).

(30) The non-primary user, user **101B** in this example, can be determined to be proximate to collaboration device **102A-1** based on collaboration device **102A-1** detecting the presence of the (non-primary) user **101B** via wireless interactions between collaboration device **102A-1** and collaboration device **102B-1** that is associated with (non-primary) user **101B** (e.g., a smartphone carried by user **101B**).

(31) Consider various operations that may be associated with providing location-aware collaboration communications via the system **100** of FIG. **1**. For example, as shown at **151**, consider that when user **101B** that is carrying collaboration device **102B-1** is proximate or near a collaboration device for which user **101B** is not the primary user, such as collaboration device **102A-1**, a wireless proximity handshake can be performed between collaboration device **102B-1** and collaboration device **102A-1** such that collaboration device **102A-1** detects the presence of collaboration device **102B-1** and, as a result user **101B**, as being near collaboration device **102A-1**.

(32) In various embodiments, the proximity handshake at **151** can be performed using any wireless communications through which location or presence of a device can be determined, such as ultrasound communications, near field communication (NFC), Bluetooth communications, etc. through which identifying information for user **101B** and/or collaboration device **102B-1** can be provided to collaboration device **102A-1**. In various embodiments, such identifying information can include any of a user identifier/identity (ID) of user **101B** stored via collaboration device **102B-1**, a hardware identifier of collaboration device **102B-1**, an identifier associated with logic configured for collaboration device **102B-1**, combinations thereof, and/or the like can be provided to collaboration device **102A-1**.

(33) In various embodiments, an identifier for a user associated with a particular collaboration device for which proximity is detected by another collaboration device may include a username, user credentials (e.g., employee ID, etc.), a network address identifier (NAI) (e.g., user**101A**@enterprise.com), an International Mobile Subscriber Identity (IMSI), a Universal Unique Identifier (UUID), certificate, any anonymous identifier that could be used to query a remote (e.g., cloud) service that could return whether a device is registered to a primary registered user or not (without providing any more/sensitive information about who the non-primary user is), combinations thereof, and/or the like. In various embodiments, a hardware identifier a particular collaboration device for which proximity is detected by another collaboration device could include a Media Access Control (MAC) address, an International Mobile Station Equipment Identity (IMEI), device/hardware fingerprinting (e.g., based on Bluetooth broadcast name and/or some combination of hardware factors/identifiers), combinations thereof and/or the like. In various embodiments, an identifier associated with logic configured for a particular collaboration device for which proximity is detected by another collaboration device could include a username for an application configured for the collaboration device (e.g., a username, etc. for a calling service, collaboration service, application installation identifier/ad tracking identifier and/or any other anonymized identifier, etc. configured for the collaboration device), logic identifying information (e.g., application identifier, version number, etc.), combinations thereof, and/or the like.

(34) Through the proximity handshake at **151**, collaboration device **102A-1** detects the presence of collaboration device **102B-1** and, as a result user **101B**, as being near collaboration device **102A-1**,

which can trigger the collaboration device **102A-1** to perform various operations as shown at **152** via control logic **104A-1** including fetching/validating information for user **101B** associated with collaboration device **102B-1** in relation to information for user **101A** that is identified as the primary user of collaboration device **102A-1** such that collaboration device **102A-1** can determine that user **101B** is not the primary user of collaboration device **102A-1**, rather user **101B** is a non-primary user that is proximate or near collaboration device **102A-1**.

(35) In some embodiments, the operations at **152** can include determining that user **101B** is associated with the enterprise entity facilitating collaboration communications via collaboration service **130** and, thus is allowed/authorized to utilize the shoulder tap functionality provided by collaboration device **102A-1**, as opposed to a foreign user that would not be allowed/authorized to utilize the shoulder tap functionality such that functionality for initiating a call to the primary user **101A** of collaboration device **102A-1** would be inhibited or disabled on the collaboration device **102A-1**. In some embodiments, the operations at **152** may include querying an authentication/authorization server or database (not shown) of the enterprise entity using the identifying information for user **101B** and/or collaboration device **102B-1** in order to identify whether user **101B** is allowed/authorized to utilize the shoulder tap functionality.

(36) The operations at **152** can include fetching/obtaining permissions and/or status information associated with user **101A** that facilitate determining that the primary user of collaboration device **102A-1**, user **101A** in this example, is not proximate or near collaboration device **102A-1**. For example, in some embodiments, collaboration device **102A-1** via control logic **104A-1** (and potentially via collaboration service **130**) can determine that user **101A** is logged-in to collaboration device **102A-2** that is located at a remote location, such as location **120**, that is not proximate or near location **110** at which collaboration device **102A-1** is located. In some embodiments, collaboration device **102A-1** via control logic **104A-1** (and potentially via collaboration service **130**) can determine that user **101A** is proximate to collaboration device **102A-2** that is located at the (remote) location **120** based on activity information for the collaboration device **102A-2** indicating that the primary user has been active on the collaboration device **102A-2** within a threshold amount of time (e.g., within the last 10 minutes, etc.). In still some embodiments, collaboration device **102A-1** can determine that user **101A** is not proximate or near collaboration device **102A-1** by collaboration device **102A-1** not performing a proximity handshake with another device associated with user **101A** (e.g., a mobile phone, etc. carried by user **101A** that might be used to detect the proximity of user **101A** being near collaboration device **102A-1**). Other information for determining that a primary user is not near a given collaboration device could be envisioned.

(37) Upon determining that the primary user of the collaboration device **102A-1**, user **101A**, is not proximate to the collaboration device **102A-1**, collaboration device **102A-1** can enable the shoulder tap functionality by enabling the non-primary user, user **101B** in this example, to utilize the collaboration device to initiate communication with another collaboration device associated with the primary user **101A**. In one at least embodiment, as shown at **153**, collaboration device **102A-1** can provide a UI button or feature for the shoulder tap functionality, which enables the non-primary user **101B** to initiate a call to another collaboration device of the primary user **101A** by providing an input to collaboration device **102A-1** (e.g., non-primary user **101B** tapping/pressing the UI button) to initiate the call. In at least one embodiment upon determining that the primary user **101A** of the collaboration device **102A-1** is not proximate to the collaboration device **102A-1**, collaboration device **102A-1** can provide the should tap functionality by automatically initiating a call to another collaboration device of the primary user (e.g., based on permissions configured by the primary user **101A** to allow such automatic communications, based on no “Do Not Disturb” settings being active for the primary user, etc.).

(38) In at least one embodiment, upon determining that the primary user, **101A**, of the collaboration device **102A-1** is not proximate to the collaboration device **102A-1**, collaboration device **102A-1**

via control logic **104A-1** can check the status of the primary user **101A** to confirm that the primary user does not have a “Do Not Disturb” setting active before enabling the communication functionality for the collaboration device **102A-1**.

(39) Upon enabling the non-primary user **101B** with the ability to utilize collaboration device **102A-1** for a communication to at least one other collaboration device of the primary user **101A**, a call or teleconference to the at least one other collaboration device of the primary user can be initiated via the collaboration device **102A-1** and collaboration service **130**, as shown at **154**. The call/teleconference can be initiated using the user ID of the non-primary user **101B** so that the primary user **101A** can identify who is calling (e.g., to avoid the primary user **101A** from thinking that they are calling themselves). In one embodiment, the process of initiating a call or teleconference could be made more personal by using “knock-knock” functionality in which an image of the calling (non-primary) user **101B** could be displayed via a collaboration device of the primary user **101A** in order for the primary user **101A** to determine who is calling before answering the call.

(40) In at least one embodiment, collaboration service **130** can direct the call to all collaboration devices associated with the primary user **101A**, such as collaboration device **102A-2** and any other collaboration devices (not shown) associated with the primary user **101A**. In another embodiment, collaboration service **130** can select, as shown at **155**, a particular collaboration device of the primary user **101A**, such as collaboration device **102A-2**, to which to direct the call based on activity information for the collaboration device **102A-2** indicating that the primary user **101A** has been active on the collaboration device **102A-2** within a threshold amount of time (e.g., within the last 5-10 minutes, etc.). In another embodiment, collaboration service **130** can select a particular collaboration device of the primary user, such as collaboration device **102A-2**, to which to direct the call based on location information for the primary user **101A** indicating their proximity being near collaboration device **102A-2**. In one embodiment, the location of primary user **101A** being proximate or near collaboration device **102A-2** can be based on location information for the primary user **101A** maintained by collaboration service **130** and/or reported by collaboration device **102A-2** to collaboration service based on a proximity handshake being performed between another collaboration device of primary user **101A** (e.g., a mobile phone carried by the primary user **101A**) and collaboration device **102A-2** in which location information for the user is reported to collaboration service **130**. Other variations for selecting a particular collaboration device of a primary user to which to direct a communication can be envisioned.

(41) Upon receiving an indication of the call on collaboration device **102A-2**, the primary user **101A** can answer the call via collaboration device **102A-2** at location **120**, as shown at **156**, to complete the call. For example, primary user can interact (click, touch, select, etc.) with collaboration device **102A-2** to answer the call.

(42) Accordingly, techniques herein may provide facilitate location-aware collaboration communications between an in-office user and a remote user via a collaboration device associated with the remote user that is located in-office, proximate to the in-office user utilizing various “shoulder tap” functionality as discussed for various embodiments. Such techniques can be utilized to bridge the gap between remote and in-person workers in order to provide opportunities for improved interaction among a higher portion of the workforce, thereby improving value that can be provided by collaboration devices owned/operated by an enterprise entity.

(43) Such techniques may also help to reduce the effect of a “siloes” workforce, for example, if somebody in the office doesn't know who members of a team they need to work with personally, but they know the area of the office where they sit, techniques as discussed for embodiments herein would enable such workers to make an initial contact more efficiently, and more personally, than, for example, initiating communication via team or group room of a collaboration service or raising a support ticket.

(44) Referring to FIG. 2, FIG. 2 is a block diagram **200** illustrating example details associated with

an example use case in which collaboration communications may be disabled for a non-primary user of a collaboration device, according to an example embodiment. FIG. 2 includes collaboration device **102A-1** and another collaboration device **102A-3** that are associated with the (primary) user **101A** and collaboration device **102B-1** that is associated with (non-primary) user **101B** in which all collaboration devices **102A-1**, **102A-3** and **102B-1** are located at location **110**.

(45) In the case where the device owner/primary user associated with a particular collaboration device, such as user **101A** associated with collaboration device **102A-1**, is present simultaneously with a non-primary user, the “shoulder tap” functionality for allowing a non-primary user of the collaboration device **102A-1**, such as user **101B**, can be disabled or otherwise inhibited on the collaboration device **102A-1**.

(46) For example, as illustrated in FIG. 2, a proximity handshake can be performed between collaboration device **102A-1** and **102B-1** associated with the non-primary user **101B**, as shown at **201**, such that collaboration device **102A-1** can detect the presence of non-primary user **101B** being proximate to collaboration device **102A-1**. Another proximity handshake can be performed between collaboration device **102A-1** and **102A-3** associated with the primary user **101A**, as shown at **202**, such that collaboration device can also detect the presence of primary user **101A** also being proximate to collaboration device **102A-1**. In some instances, the behavior at **202** may be suppressed. For example, if certain collaboration devices are always together such that if a user has a device and a desktop that stay in the same place, logic could be configured to ignore such proximities of commonly located devices in which case other devices/mechanisms could be used to determine primary user **101A** proximity as being near/proximate to collaboration device **102A-1** (e.g., the primary user is active/has been recently (within a threshold amount of time) logged-in to collaboration device **102A-1**, or similar logic).

(47) Based on collaboration device **102A-1** determining that the primary user **101A** of the collaboration device **102A-1** is proximate to or near the collaboration device **102A-1**, the “shoulder tap” functionality can be disabled for the collaboration device **102A-1**, as shown at **203**, such that the non-primary user **101B** would be inhibited from utilizing the collaboration device **102A-1** to initiate collaboration communications with another collaboration device of the primary user **101A**.

(48) Referring to FIG. 3, FIG. 3 is a flow chart depicting a method **300** according to an example embodiment. In at least one embodiment, operations associated with method **300** may be performed, at least in part, by a collaboration device of a user, such as collaboration device **102A-1** associated with primary user **101A**, as discussed for embodiments herein.

(49) At **302**, the method may include determining, by a first device associated with a first user (e.g., collaboration device **102A-1** associated with user **101A**) proximity of a second device of a second user (e.g., collaboration device **102B-1**). In one embodiment, the determining at **302** can be based on a proximity handshake or other proximity detection mechanism through which the first device can detect that the second device is proximate to or near the first device.

(50) At **304**, the method may include the first device determining whether the second device is associated a non-primary user that could be allowed/authorized to utilize a shoulder tap functionality of the first device or is associated with a foreign user that would not be allowed/authorized to utilize the shoulder tap functionality. In some embodiments, operations performed at **304** may include querying an authentication/authorization server or database (not shown) stored locally on the first device or accessible remotely by the first device using the identifying information for the second user and/or the second device obtained through the proximity handshake/proximity detection of the second device.

(51) In one instance, if the first device determines at **304** that the second device is associated with a foreign user, the operations may continue to **308** at which the first device disables the shoulder tap functionality, and the method may end.

(52) In another instance, if the first device determines at **304** that the second device is associated with a non-primary, but allowed/authorized, user that may utilize the shoulder tap functionality of

the first device, the operations can continue to **306** at which the first device can determine whether the first user of the first device is proximate to the first device. For example, if the first device performs a proximity handshake with another device of the first user (e.g., a mobile phone of the first user), then the first device can determine that the first user is proximate to the first device (YES at **306**) such that the operations can proceed to **308** at which the first device disables the shoulder tap functionality, and the method may end. Other operations may be performed to determine whether the first user is proximate to the first device (e.g., determining that the first user is logged-in to another device at a location different than the location of the first device, determining a location of the first user being different than the location of the first device, etc.).

(53) Returning to the operations at **306**, upon determining by the first device that the first user is not proximate to the first device, the operations can continue to **310** at which the first device can enable the shoulder tap functionality in order to enable the second (non-primary) user to initiate communication with at least one other device associated with the first (primary) user via a corresponding collaboration service that facilitates communications for devices associated with the first and second user. The communication can be initiated using a user identity of the second (non-primary) user. In one embodiment, the communication can be initiated by the second (non-primary) user based on at least one user input provided to the first device by the second user (e.g., tapping a “call” button, etc.). In one embodiment, the communication can be initiated automatically by the first device. In one embodiment, the communication can be initiated automatically by the first device following confirmation by the first device that the first user has not activated any mechanism/permission/setting to prohibit such communications, such as activating a “Do Not Disturb” setting for the collaboration service by the first user, etc.

(54) Referring to FIG. 4, FIG. 4 is a flow chart depicting another method **400** according to an example embodiment. In at least one embodiment, operations associated with method **400** may be performed, at least in part, by a collaboration device of a user, such as collaboration device **102A-1** associated with primary user **101A**, as discussed for embodiments herein.

(55) At **402**, the method may include determining, by a first collaboration device, that a non-primary user of the first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device. In one embodiment, the determining at **402** can be based on a proximity handshake or other proximity detection mechanism through which the first collaboration device can detect that a collaboration device associated with the non-primary user being proximate to or near the first collaboration device. The detecting can be based on wireless communications between the first collaboration device and the collaboration device of the non-primary user through which the first collaboration device determines that the collaboration device is associated with the non-primary user based on identifying information determined/obtained for the non-primary user and/or the device of the non-primary user. The identifying information can include any combination of a user identifier associated with the non-primary user, a hardware identifier associated with the collaboration device of the non-primary user, and/or an identifier associated with logic configured for the collaboration device of the non-primary user.

(56) At **404**, the method may include based on determining that a primary user of the first collaboration device is not proximate to the first collaboration device, enabling the non-primary user to utilize the first collaboration device to initiate communication with at least one second collaboration device of the primary user. In one embodiment the first collaboration device can initiate the communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user upon obtaining an input from the non-primary user to the first collaboration device. In one embodiment, the first collaboration device can automatically initiate the communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user without the non-primary user interacting with the first collaboration device.

(57) Referring to FIG. 5, FIG. 5 illustrates a hardware block diagram of a computing device **500** that may perform functions associated with operations discussed herein. In various embodiments, a

computing device or apparatus, such as computing device **500** or any combination of computing devices **500**, may be configured as any entity/entities as discussed herein (e.g., collaboration device **102A-1**, **102A-2**, **102A-3**, and/or **102B-1** and/or any combination of devices facilitating collaboration service **130**) in order to perform operations of the various techniques discussed herein.

(58) In at least one embodiment, computing device **500** may be any apparatus that may include one or more processor(s) **502**, one or more memory element(s) **504**, storage **506**, a bus **508**, one or more I/O interface(s) **516**, control logic **520** (e.g., calendar logic/scheduling logic, as discussed herein), one or more one network processor unit(s) **530** and one or more network I/O interface(s) **532**. In various embodiments, instructions associated with logic for computing device **500** can overlap in any manner and are not limited to the specific allocation of instructions and/or operations described herein.

(59) For embodiments in which computing device **500** may be implemented as any device capable of wireless communications (e.g., collaboration devices **102A-1**, **102B-1**, and **102A-3**), computing device **500** may further include at least one baseband processor or modem **510**, one or more radio RF transceiver(s) **512**, one or more antenna(s) or antenna array(s) **514**.

(60) In at least one embodiment, processor(s) **502** is/are at least one hardware processor configured to execute various tasks, operations and/or functions for computing device **500** as described herein according to software and/or instructions configured for computing device **500**. Processor(s) **502** (e.g., a hardware processor) can execute any type of instructions associated with data to achieve the operations detailed herein. In one example, processor(s) **502** can transform an element or an article (e.g., data, information) from one state or thing to another state or thing. Any of potential processing elements, graphical processing units (GPUs), microprocessors, digital signal processor, baseband signal processor, modem, physical layer (PHY), computing devices, systems, managers, logic, and/or machines described herein can be construed as being encompassed within the broad term 'processor'.

(61) In at least one embodiment, memory element(s) **504** and/or storage **506** is/are configured to store data, information, software, and/or instructions associated with computing device **500**, and/or logic configured for memory element(s) **504** and/or storage **506**. For example, any logic described herein (e.g., control logic **520**) can, in various embodiments, be stored for computing device **500** using any combination of memory element(s) **504** and/or storage **506**. Note that in some embodiments, storage **506** can be consolidated with memory element(s) **504** (or vice versa) or can overlap/exist in any other suitable manner.

(62) In at least one embodiment, bus **508** can be configured as an interface that enables one or more elements of computing device **500** to communicate in order to exchange information and/or data. Bus **508** can be implemented with any architecture designed for passing control, data and/or information between processors, memory elements/storage, peripheral devices, and/or any other hardware and/or software components that are configured for computing device **500**. In at least one embodiment, bus **508** is implemented as a fast kernel-hosted interconnect, potentially using shared memory between processes (e.g., logic), which can enable efficient communication paths between the processes.

(63) Network processor unit(s) **530** may enable communication between computing device **500** and other systems, devices, or entities, via network I/O interface(s) **532** (wired and/or wireless) to facilitate operations discussed for various embodiments described herein. In various embodiments, network processor unit(s) **530** can be configured as a combination of hardware and/or software, such as one or more Ethernet driver(s) and/or computing device(s) or interface cards, Fibre Channel (e.g., optical) driver(s) and/or computing device(s), wireless receivers/transmitters/transceivers, baseband processor(s)/modem(s), and/or other similar network interface driver(s) and/or computing device(s) now known or hereafter developed to enable communications between computing device **500** and other systems, devices, or entities to facilitate

operations for various embodiments described herein. In various embodiments, network I/O interface(s) **532** can be configured as one or more Ethernet port(s), Fibre Channel ports, any other I/O port(s), and/or antenna(s)/antenna array(s) now known or hereafter developed. Thus, the network processor unit(s) **530** and/or network I/O interface(s) **532** may include suitable interfaces for receiving, transmitting, and/or otherwise communicating data and/or information (wired and/or wirelessly) in a network environment.

(64) I/O interface(s) **516** allow for input and output of data and/or information with other entities that are connected to computing device **500**. For example, I/O interface(s) **516** may provide a connection to external devices such as a keyboard, keypad, a touch screen, and/or any other suitable input and/or output device now known or hereafter developed. In some instances, external devices can also include portable computer readable (non-transitory) storage media such as database systems, thumb drives, portable optical or magnetic disks, and memory cards. In still some instances, external devices can be a mechanism to display data to a user, such as, for example, a computer monitor, a display screen. In some embodiments, the computing device **500** supports a display having touch-screen display capabilities.

(65) For embodiments in which computing device **500** is implemented as a user device or any other apparatus capable of wireless communications, the RF transceiver(s) **512** may perform RF transmission and RF reception of wireless signals via antenna(s)/antenna array(s) **514**, and the baseband processor or modem **510** performs baseband modulation and demodulation, etc. associated with such signals to enable wireless communications for computing device **500**.

(66) In various embodiments, control logic **520** can include instructions that, when executed, cause processor(s) **502** to perform operations, which can include, but not be limited to, providing overall control operations of computing device **500**; interacting with other entities, elements, systems, etc. described herein; maintaining and/or interacting with stored data, information, parameters, etc. (e.g., memory element(s), storage, data structures, databases, tables, etc.); combinations thereof; and/or the like to facilitate various operations for embodiments described herein.

(67) The programs described herein (e.g., control logic **520** of computing device **500**) may be identified based upon application(s) for which they are implemented in a specific embodiment. However, it should be appreciated that any particular program nomenclature herein is used merely for convenience; thus, embodiments herein should not be limited to use(s) solely described in any specific application(s) identified and/or implied by such nomenclature.

(68) In various embodiments, any entity or apparatus as described herein may store data/information in any suitable volatile and/or non-volatile memory item (e.g., magnetic hard disk drive, solid state hard drive, semiconductor storage device, random access memory (RAM), read only memory (ROM), erasable programmable read only memory (EPROM), application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), etc.), software, logic (fixed logic, hardware logic, programmable logic, analog logic, digital logic), hardware, and/or in any other suitable component, device, element, and/or object as may be appropriate. Any of the memory items discussed herein should be construed as being encompassed within the broad term 'memory element'. Data/information being tracked and/or sent to one or more entities as discussed herein could be provided in any database, table, and register, list, cache, storage, and/or storage structure: all of which can be referenced at any suitable timeframe. Any such storage options may also be included within the broad term 'memory element' as used herein.

(69) Note that in certain example implementations, operations as set forth herein may be implemented by logic encoded in one or more tangible media that is capable of storing instructions and/or digital information and may be inclusive of non-transitory tangible media and/or non-transitory computer readable storage media (e.g., embedded logic provided in: an ASIC, digital signal processing (DSP) instructions, software [potentially inclusive of object code and source code], etc.) for execution by one or more processor(s), and/or other similar machine, etc. Generally, memory element(s) (e.g., memory element(s) **504** of computing device **500**) and/or storage (e.g.,

storage 506 of computing device 500) can store data, software, code, instructions (e.g., processor instructions), logic, parameters, combinations thereof, and/or the like used for operations described herein. This includes memory element(s) 504 and/or storage 506 being able to store data, software, code, instructions (e.g., processor instructions), logic, parameters, combinations thereof, or the like that are executed to carry out operations in accordance with teachings of the present disclosure.

(70) In some instances, software of the present embodiments may be available via a non-transitory computer useable medium (e.g., magnetic or optical mediums, magneto-optic mediums, CD-ROM, DVD, memory devices, etc.) of a stationary or portable program product apparatus, downloadable file(s), file wrapper(s), object(s), package(s), container(s), and/or the like. In some instances, non-transitory computer readable storage media may also be removable. For example, a removable hard drive may be used for memory/storage in some implementations. Other examples may include optical and magnetic disks, thumb drives, and smart cards that can be inserted and/or otherwise connected to a computing device for transfer onto another computer readable storage medium.

(71) In one form, a computer-implemented method is provided that may include determining that a non-primary user of a first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device; and based on determining that a primary user of the first collaboration device is not proximate to the first collaboration device, enabling the non-primary user to utilize the first collaboration device to initiate communication with at least one second collaboration device of the primary user.

(72) In one instance, determining that the non-primary user of the first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device is based on the first collaboration device detecting a third collaboration device that is associated with the non-primary user being proximate to the first collaboration device. In one instance, the detecting is based on wireless communications between the first collaboration device and the third collaboration device of the non-primary user and the detecting includes determining that the third collaboration device is associated with the non-primary user.

(73) In one instance, determining that the third collaboration device is associated with the non-primary user is based on at least one of: a user identifier associated with the non-primary user; a hardware identifier associated with the third collaboration device of the non-primary user; or an identifier associated with logic configured for the third collaboration device of the non-primary user.

(74) In one instance, the enabling includes: determining a particular second collaboration device with which to initiate the communication based on activity information for the particular second collaboration device indicating that the primary user has been active on the particular second collaboration device within a threshold amount of time.

(75) In one instance, the method may further include one of: the first collaboration device initiating the communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user upon obtaining an input from the non-primary user to the first collaboration device; or the first collaboration device automatically initiating the communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user without the non-primary user interacting with the first collaboration device. In one instance, the communication is initiated using a user identity of the non-primary user.

(76) In one instance, the method may further include based on determining that the primary user of a first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device, disabling the non-primary user from utilizing the first collaboration device to initiate communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user.

(77) Variations and Implementations

(78) Embodiments described herein may include one or more networks, which can represent a series of points and/or network elements of interconnected communication paths for receiving and/or transmitting messages (e.g., packets of information) that propagate through the one or more networks. These network elements offer communicative interfaces that facilitate communications

between the network elements. A network can include any number of hardware and/or software elements coupled to (and in communication with) each other through a communication medium. Such networks can include, but are not limited to, any local area network (LAN), virtual LAN (VLAN), wide area network (WAN) (e.g., the Internet), software defined WAN (SD-WAN), wireless local area (WLA) access network, wireless wide area (WWA) access network, metropolitan area network (MAN), Intranet, Extranet, virtual private network (VPN), Low Power Network (LPN), Low Power Wide Area Network (LPWAN), Machine to Machine (M2M) network, Internet of Things (IoT) network, Ethernet network/switching system, any other appropriate architecture and/or system that facilitates communications in a network environment, and/or any suitable combination thereof.

(79) Networks through which communications propagate can use any suitable technologies for communications including wireless communications (e.g., 4G/5G/nG, IEEE 802.11 (e.g., Wi-Fi®/Wi-Fi6®), IEEE 802.16 (e.g., Worldwide Interoperability for Microwave Access (WiMAX)), Radio-Frequency Identification (RFID), Near Field Communication (NFC), Bluetooth™ mm.wave, Ultra-Wideband (UWB), etc.), and/or wired communications (e.g., T1 lines, T3 lines, digital subscriber lines (DSL), Ethernet, Fibre Channel, etc.). Generally, any suitable means of communications may be used such as electric, sound, light, infrared, and/or radio to facilitate communications through one or more networks in accordance with embodiments herein.

Communications, interactions, operations, etc. as discussed for various embodiments described herein may be performed among entities that may directly or indirectly connected utilizing any algorithms, communication protocols, interfaces, etc. (proprietary and/or non-proprietary) that allow for the exchange of data and/or information.

(80) In various example implementations, any entity or apparatus for various embodiments described herein can encompass network elements (which can include virtualized network elements, functions, etc.) such as, for example, network appliances, forwarders, routers, servers, switches, gateways, bridges, load balancers, firewalls, processors, modules, radio receivers/transmitters, and/or any other suitable device, component, element, or object operable to exchange information that facilitates or otherwise helps to facilitate various operations in a network environment as described for various embodiments herein. Note that with the examples provided herein, interaction may be described in terms of one, two, three, or four entities. However, this has been done for purposes of clarity, simplicity and example only. The examples provided should not limit the scope or inhibit the broad teachings of systems, networks, etc. described herein as potentially applied to a myriad of other architectures.

(81) Communications in a network environment can be referred to herein as ‘messages’, ‘messaging’, ‘signaling’, ‘data’, ‘content’, ‘objects’, ‘requests’, ‘queries’, ‘responses’, ‘replies’, etc. which may be inclusive of packets. As referred to herein and in the claims, the term ‘packet’ may be used in a generic sense to include packets, frames, segments, datagrams, and/or any other generic units that may be used to transmit communications in a network environment. Generally, a packet is a formatted unit of data that can contain control or routing information (e.g., source and destination address, source and destination port, etc.) and data, which is also sometimes referred to as a ‘payload’, ‘data payload’, and variations thereof. In some embodiments, control or routing information, management information, or the like can be included in packet fields, such as within header(s) and/or trailer(s) of packets. Internet Protocol (IP) addresses discussed herein and, in the claims, can include any IP version 4 (IPv4) and/or IP version 6 (IPv6) addresses.

(82) To the extent that embodiments presented herein relate to the storage of data, the embodiments may employ any number of any conventional or other databases, data stores or storage structures (e.g., files, databases, data structures, data or other repositories, etc.) to store information.

(83) Note that in this Specification, references to various features (e.g., elements, structures, nodes, modules, components, engines, logic, steps, operations, functions, characteristics, etc.) included in ‘one embodiment’, ‘example embodiment’, ‘an embodiment’, ‘another embodiment’, ‘certain

embodiments', 'some embodiments', 'various embodiments', 'other embodiments', 'alternative embodiment', and the like are intended to mean that any such features are included in one or more embodiments of the present disclosure, but may or may not necessarily be combined in the same embodiments. Note also that a module, engine, client, controller, function, logic or the like as used herein in this Specification, can be inclusive of an executable file comprising instructions that can be understood and processed on a server, computer, processor, machine, compute node, combinations thereof, or the like and may further include library modules loaded during execution, object files, system files, hardware logic, software logic, or any other executable modules.

(84) It is also noted that the operations and steps described with reference to the preceding figures illustrate only some of the possible scenarios that may be executed by one or more entities discussed herein. Some of these operations may be deleted or removed where appropriate, or these steps may be modified or changed considerably without departing from the scope of the presented concepts. In addition, the timing and sequence of these operations may be altered considerably and still achieve the results taught in this disclosure. The preceding operational flows have been offered for purposes of example and discussion. Substantial flexibility is provided by the embodiments in that any suitable arrangements, chronologies, configurations, and timing mechanisms may be provided without departing from the teachings of the discussed concepts.

(85) As used herein, unless expressly stated to the contrary, use of the phrase 'at least one of', 'one or more of', 'and/or', variations thereof, or the like are open-ended expressions that are both conjunctive and disjunctive in operation for any and all possible combination of the associated listed items. For example, each of the expressions 'at least one of X, Y and Z', 'at least one of X, Y or Z', 'one or more of X, Y and Z', 'one or more of X, Y or Z' and 'X, Y and/or Z' can mean any of the following: 1) X, but not Y and not Z; 2) Y, but not X and not Z; 3) Z, but not X and not Y; 4) X and Y, but not Z; 5) X and Z, but not Y; 6) Y and Z, but not X; or 7) X, Y, and Z.

(86) Additionally, unless expressly stated to the contrary, the terms 'first', 'second', 'third', etc., are intended to distinguish the particular nouns they modify (e.g., element, condition, node, module, activity, operation, etc.). Unless expressly stated to the contrary, the use of these terms is not intended to indicate any type of order, rank, importance, temporal sequence, or hierarchy of the modified noun. For example, 'first X' and 'second X' are intended to designate two 'X' elements that are not necessarily limited by any order, rank, importance, temporal sequence, or hierarchy of the two elements. Further as referred to herein, 'at least one of' and 'one or more of' can be represented using the '(s)' nomenclature (e.g., one or more element(s)).

(87) Each example embodiment disclosed herein has been included to present one or more different features. However, all disclosed example embodiments are designed to work together as part of a single larger system or method. This disclosure explicitly envisions compound embodiments that combine multiple previously discussed features in different example embodiments into a single system or method.

(88) One or more advantages described herein are not meant to suggest that any one of the embodiments described herein necessarily provides all of the described advantages or that all the embodiments of the present disclosure necessarily provide any one of the described advantages. Numerous other changes, substitutions, variations, alterations, and/or modifications may be ascertained to one skilled in the art and it is intended that the present disclosure encompass all such changes, substitutions, variations, alterations, and/or modifications as falling within the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A method comprising: determining that a non-primary user of a first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device; and based on determining that a primary user of the first collaboration device is not proximate to the first collaboration device, enabling the non-primary

- user to utilize the first collaboration device to initiate communication with at least one second collaboration device of the primary user.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein determining that the non-primary user of the first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device is based on the first collaboration device detecting a third collaboration device that is associated with the non-primary user being proximate to the first collaboration device.
 3. The method of claim 2, wherein the detecting is based on wireless communications between the first collaboration device and the third collaboration device of the non-primary user and the detecting includes determining that the third collaboration device is associated with the non-primary user.
 4. The method of claim 3, wherein determining that the third collaboration device is associated with the non-primary user is based on at least one of: a user identifier associated with the non-primary user; a hardware identifier associated with the third collaboration device of the non-primary user; or an identifier associated with logic configured for the third collaboration device of the non-primary user.
 5. The method of claim 1, wherein the enabling includes: determining a particular second collaboration device with which to initiate the communication based on activity information for the particular second collaboration device indicating that the primary user has been active on the particular second collaboration device within a threshold amount of time.
 6. The method of claim 1, further comprising one of: the first collaboration device initiating the communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user upon obtaining an input from the non-primary user to the first collaboration device; or the first collaboration device automatically initiating the communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user without the non-primary user interacting with the first collaboration device.
 7. The method of claim 6, wherein the communication is initiated using a user identity of the non-primary user.
 8. The method of claim 1, further comprising: based on determining that the primary user of a first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device, disabling the non-primary user from utilizing the first collaboration device to initiate communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user.
 9. One or more non-transitory computer readable storage media encoded with instructions that, when executed by a processor, cause the processor to perform operations, comprising: determining that a non-primary user of a first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device; and based on determining that a primary user of the first collaboration device is not proximate to the first collaboration device, enabling the non-primary user to utilize the first collaboration device to initiate communication with at least one second collaboration device of the primary user.
 10. The media of claim 9, wherein determining that the non-primary user of the first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device is based on the first collaboration device detecting a third collaboration device that is associated with the non-primary user being proximate to the first collaboration device.
 11. The media of claim 10, wherein the detecting is based on wireless communications between the first collaboration device and the third collaboration device of the non-primary user and the detecting includes determining that the third collaboration device is associated with the non-primary user.
 12. The media of claim 11, wherein determining that the third collaboration device is associated with the non-primary user is based on at least one of: a user identifier associated with the non-primary user; a hardware identifier associated with the third collaboration device of the non-primary user; or an identifier associated with logic configured for the third collaboration device of the non-primary user.

13. The media of claim 9, wherein the enabling includes: determining a particular second collaboration device with which to initiate the communication based on activity information for the particular second collaboration device indicating that the primary user has been active on the particular second collaboration device within a threshold amount of time.
14. The media of claim 9, further encoded with instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to perform further operations, comprising one of: the first collaboration device initiating the communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user upon obtaining an input from the non-primary user to the first collaboration device; or the first collaboration device automatically initiating the communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user without the non-primary user interacting with the first collaboration device.
15. The media of claim 9, further encoded with instructions that, when executed by the processor, cause the processor to perform further operations, comprising: based on determining that the primary user of a first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device, disabling the non-primary user from utilizing the first collaboration device to initiate communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user.
16. A first collaboration device comprising: at least one memory element for storing data; and at least one processor for executing instructions associated with the data, wherein executing the instructions causes the first collaboration device to perform operations, comprising: determining that a non-primary user of the first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device; and based on determining that a primary user of the first collaboration device is not proximate to the first collaboration device, enabling the non-primary user to utilize the first collaboration device to initiate communication with at least one second collaboration device of the primary user.
17. The first collaboration device of claim 16, wherein determining that the non-primary user of the first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device is based on the first collaboration device detecting a third collaboration device that is associated with the non-primary user being proximate to the first collaboration device.
18. The first collaboration device of claim 17, wherein the detecting is based on wireless communications between the first collaboration device and the third collaboration device of the non-primary user and the detecting includes determining that the third collaboration device is associated with the non-primary user.
19. The first collaboration device of claim 16, wherein executing the instructions causes the first collaboration device to perform further operations, comprising one of: the first collaboration device initiating the communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user upon obtaining an input from the non-primary user to the first collaboration device; or the first collaboration device automatically initiating the communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user without the non-primary user interacting with the first collaboration device.
20. The first collaboration device of claim 16, wherein executing the instructions causes the first collaboration device to perform further operations, comprising: based on determining that the primary user of a first collaboration device is proximate to the first collaboration device, disabling the non-primary user from utilizing the first collaboration device to initiate communication with the at least one second collaboration device of the primary user.
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